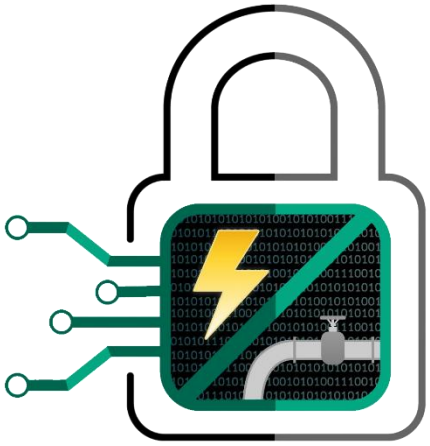


U.S. DEPARTMENT OF ENERGY'S

CYBERFORCE COMPETITION®

DEFENDING U.S. ENERGY INFRASTRUCTURE

OVERVIEW, RULES, & SCORING

2026

CYBERFORCE COMPETITION®

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COMPETITION OVERVIEW

OVERVIEW

The CyberForce Competition® has been a pinnacle of workforce development for the Department of Energy (DOE), national laboratories, and industry since 2016. Through the CyberForce Competition, DOE has worked to increase 1) hands-on cyber education to college students and professionals, 2) awareness of the critical infrastructure and cyber security nexus, and 3) basic understanding of cyber security within a real-world scenario.

NOTE TO PARTICIPANTS

- For the purposes of competition, you are the **BLUE TEAM**.
- Overall scoring breakdown can be found later in this document. **PLEASE TAKE A MOMENT TO REVIEW THIS DOCUMENT THOROUGHLY AND COMPLETELY**.
- This year, each team will be provided six (6) ethernet cables to connect to the internet. It is each participant's responsibility to bring the appropriate dongle or connector for their machine as nothing will be provided. Wireless connections will still be available.

KEY DATES

Monday, October 26, 2026	Students are provided with their C-Suite Scenario. Students are provided with instructions to log into the controller.
Tuesday, October 27, 2026 6:00pm CT (4:00pm PT)	C-Suite Fireside Chat *(optional & recorded)*
Monday, November 2, 2026 10:00am CT (8:00am PT)	C-Suite Panel video due
Monday, November 2, 2026	Students are provided with directions for accessing the rules. Students are provided with access to AWS.
Monday, November 2, 2026 6:00pm CT (4:00pm PT)	Rules Fireside Chat *(optional & recorded)*
Monday, November 9, 2026 10:00am CT (8:00am PT)	Security Documentation due
Friday, November 13, 2026 11:00am – 8:00pm CT @ Tinley Park Convention Center, Illinois	Students are provided with extended help support hours with competition staff to answer any final questions. Red team and Blue team mandatory check in
Saturday, November 14, 2026	Competition Day

SCENARIO

FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY – 2026 CYBERFORCE COMPETITION® SCENARIO

CONTRACTOR ACTIVATION GUIDE

Vulcana Dynamics Ltd.

FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY – 2026 CYBERFORCE COMPETITION® SCENARIO

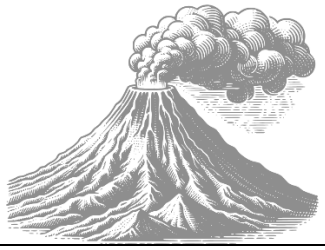
FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY – 2026 CYBERFORCE COMPETITION® SCENARIO

Activation

Your team is being activated as part of the operations team for Vulcana Dynamics Ltd. (VDL); the sole power utility responsible for electricity generation, transmission, and distribution across the Kaldera Archipelago. This is a strategically vital island chain in a contested maritime zone. Built on the extraordinary geothermal resources of the archipelago's volcanic geology, VDL has operated the grid for decades as the sole bulk electricity service across the island chain.

The archipelago's only defense against airspace and maritime intrusion is its Island Defense Radar Network: a pair of long-range radar installations on outlying islands, dependent entirely on uninterrupted electrical power from the VDL grid. No secondary power grid or backup generation exists at the radar sites. If the grid fails, the islands and the radar go dark.

The Island Defense Radar Network provides 360-degree surveillance coverage across the Kaldera Archipelago. It is the archipelago's only early-warning system. Two radar installations, one on the northern atoll and one on the southern reef, feed continuous tracking data to the Air Defense Operations Centre on Kaldera Main.



FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY – 2026 CYBERFORCE COMPETITION® SCENARIO

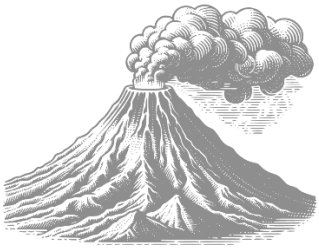
FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY – 2026 CYBERFORCE COMPETITION® SCENARIO

Current Status

As of last night, the grid experienced an outage of approximately two minutes and thirty-six seconds. It is currently unknown as to what caused this outage. The system is back up and running, but VDL must ensure no malicious activity was behind this outage. Your team has control of the entire power system. The grid is live, the radar is operational, and conditions in the field are already showing signs of stress.

Under the Defense Infrastructure Partnership Act, VDL is legally designated as a Critical National Infrastructure Operator, carrying obligations that go well beyond keeping the lights on for civilian customers. When the defense authority calls, VDL answers.

Decisions will need to be made quickly and under pressure. Some response options are fast but carry risk. Others are safe but cost time and output. There is rarely a perfect answer, only better and worse tradeoffs. The teams that win communicate clearly, protect the defense feed above all else, and never let a small problem become a cascade.



FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY – 2026 CYBERFORCE COMPETITION® SCENARIO

Contract Period

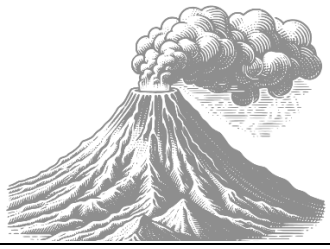
Start: Monday, October 26, 2026 - 6:00pm CT
End: Saturday, November 14, 2026 - 6:00pm CT

Team Requirements

Your team should have no less than 4 but no more than 6 team members.

Budget

No additional funding will be provided for this contracted period. All solutions should be considered widely available.



COMPETITION STRUCTURE

COMMUNICATION FLOW

For the remainder of this document, students are classified as the **BLUE TEAM**.

Blue	A Blue team is composed of collegiate students who defend their network infrastructure from the Red team and maintain system usability for the Green team.
Red	The Red team includes industry security professionals that play the role of cyber attackers or "hackers" attempting to breach the Blue network infrastructure and defenses of the Blue team participants.
Green	The Green team includes volunteers with a variety of skill sets, to emulate typical end users.
White	The White team includes national laboratory employees who support the participants in setting up their infrastructure and judge the competition.
Orange	The Orange team includes volunteers who play the role of a C-suite within a mock organization who review videos and security documentation.

SETUP PHASE

Blue teams will be given access to their AWS environment no later than Monday, November 2, 2026. Blue teams should use this time to assess, build, secure, and test their system prior to the competition as well as familiarizing themselves with the competition scenario. Blue teams should continue to prepare their Security Documentation and their C-Suite video until their due dates.

ATTACK PHASE

On the day of the competition (Saturday, November 14), the Red team will attempt to gain access to Blue team services on the traditional infrastructure and already have access to the assume breach infrastructure. Meanwhile, the Green team will be responsible for evaluating the Blue team's web services and system operations. The White team will assess Blue team service uptime. Throughout the competition, Blue teams must monitor their systems, answer anomalies, and maintain their website for Green team users.

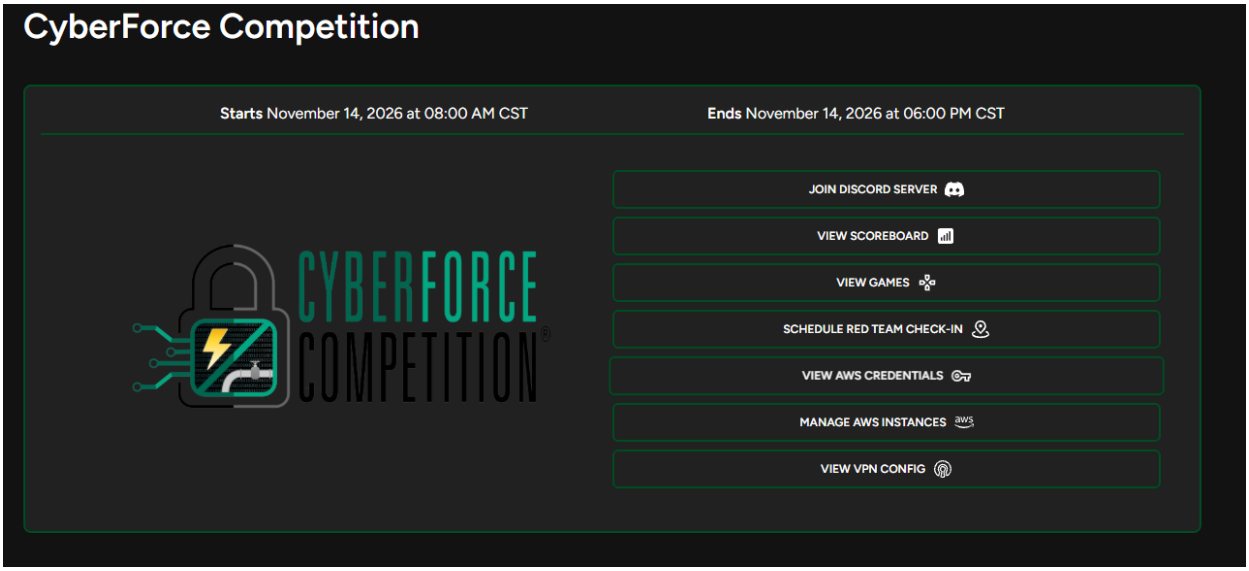
During this phase, Blue teams may not receive help from anyone external from the 4-6 members on a team. Receiving help from others, including mentors, external parties, etc., will result in disqualification.

GETTING STARTED: PRE-COMPETITION

CONTROLLER

Students and mentors will need to visit HTTPS://CONTROLLER.CYBERFORCECOMPETITION.COM/ and register using the .edu email you registered with for the competition (the one you have been receiving emails to). *If you participated in the 2025 CyberForce Competition or either of the 2025 Conquer the Hill competitions AND you used the same email to register; you will already have an account.* There is a "Forgot password" function available.

This will be the main dashboard that will be used for navigating your competition needs. It will be where you join Discord, view the Scoreboard, participate in CyberForce games for raffle tickets, get your AWS Credentials, manage your AWS snapshots, and get your VPN files. *Note*: not all items will be available right away.



DISCORD

- Discord is **required** for support throughout the competition timeframe. There will not be any technical support for students via email leading up to the competition or in-person on the day of.

NAMING CONVENTION

- By joining the competition Discord server via the controller, students and mentors will auto-populate with their team number as a prefix to their name. This will add each student to their team's red-blue bridge channel and provide them with the Blue Team role/access. Mentors will **NOT** be added to the bridge channel but will be provided with the Mentor role/access.
- In the event you need your nickname changed (e.g., you don't go by your full name), please submit a "Controller" ticket type and provide the name you do use. This must be appropriate, and staff have the right to not accept a request.

DISCORD RULES & SUPPORT

- Tampering with Discord bots, channels, or other teams' tickets will result in disqualification.
- Participants are encouraged to assist one another in the designated Discord channels, except for providing answers for anomalies or other scored items during the competition.
- **DO NOT DM** admins or staff, each violation will result in a 10-point deduction.

HELP DESK

If students need technical help from the White Team, they must submit a help desk ticket **in Discord**. The help desk is monitored only during regular business hours (Monday–Friday, 8am-5pm CT) before the competition. Tickets will be monitored all day Friday, November 13 and Saturday, November 14 with shorter response rate requirements. It is the responsibility of the **ticket submitter** to ensure they are responding to questions/answers promptly

- The Help Desk will operate via the #ticket-system channel.
    - Students needing assistance before or during the competition must submit a ticket.
    - Additional ticket types may be announced as needed.
    - Please only submit one ticket per issue and be cognizant of which ticket type you select.

- When submitting a ticket, be as specific as possible and select the correct topic. Avoid combining unrelated issues into one ticket.
- Check the *#announcements* and *#documentation* channels for updates **before** creating a ticket.

EMAIL

Students may email CyberForceCompetition@anl.gov for LOGISTICAL ISSUES ONLY. Please note, this email is only monitored during normal business hours (Monday–Friday, 8am-5pm CT). This email will not be monitored Thursday, November 12 – Saturday, November 14, 2026, please be sure to use the help desk system.

COMPETITION ENVIRONMENT

NETWORK TOPOLOGY

- You will inherit a /27 AWS VPC subnet
- Any changes to your Blue team infrastructure must be clearly documented in Security Documentation.

LOGIN INSTRUCTIONS

VPN INSTALL INSTRUCTIONS

The competition uses OpenVPN for access to the AWS environment. You will be provided with an OVPN configuration file to connect to your network. Students should be mindful that we support only these community clients for each operating system can be found below:

- Windows – OpenVPN Community - https://openvpn.net/community-downloads/
  - Place the OVPN file into "C:\Program Files\Openvpn\config".
- MacOS – Tunnelblick - https://www.tunnelblick.net or https://openvpn.net/client-connect-vpn-for-mac-os/
  - Double click the OVPN file to import it to Tunnelblick
- Linux – sudo apt (or yum) install openvpn
  - Run "openvpn --config YOUR_OVPN_FILE.ovpn"

AWS & SCOREBOARD CREDENTIALS

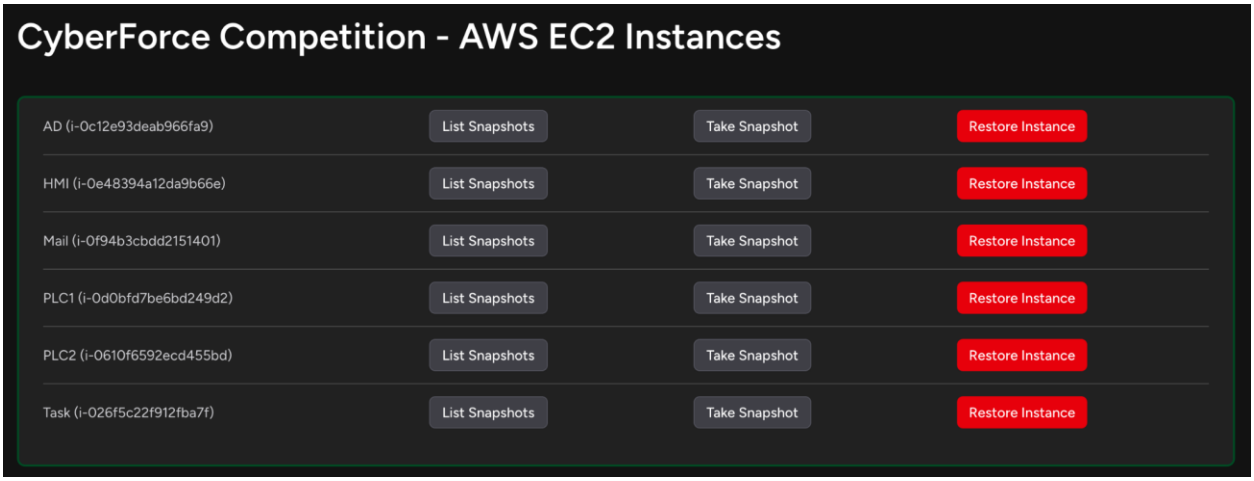
Students will need to visit HTTPS://CONTROLLER.CYBERFORCECOMPETITION.COM/ site as mentioned above to receive their AWS credentials or utilize the scoreboard. It is each team member's responsibility to ensure they register with the controller to ensure they get adequate time to prepare. Within the controller, you can sign into AWS, reset your AWS password, and download your team's VPN files. Additional instructions are available in the CyberForce Competition AWS document.

- Limits have been placed on *snapshot revert* to 2 reverts per VM per hour.
- IAM password reset cooldown every 15 minutes.

Scored services can be tested the week before the competition. Services should be connected by Friday, November 13, 2026, to ensure that scoring is accurate as soon as the competition starts. It is each team's responsibility to input C-Suite submissions, Security Documentation submissions, etc. into the scoreboard.

RESTORING SYSTEMS TO INITIAL STATE

If a Blue team damages any virtual machines beyond the point of recovery, you may restore to a fresh, default image of the system using the Controller. However, your team will incur a scoring penalty of **75 points per VM restoration**. To prevent a scoring penalty, your team is encouraged to create disk snapshots of each system as it is set up and configured, especially before and after any significant infrastructure changes.



KEY RULES

- **No Offensive Actions**: Blue team participants may not engage in offensive actions against other Blue teams, the Red team, the Green team, scoreboard, the competition network/infrastructure, or the hosting venue infrastructure/network. Violations will result in disqualification.
- **Team Number Usage**: Use the provided Excel document to find your specific four-digit team number whenever "BLUEXXXX" or "TEAMNUMBER" is referenced.
- **AWS Access**: Blue team members will have AWS environment access by November 2, 2026. Administrative accounts are managed by the White team and will only be used for scoring and rule enforcement.
- **Confidentiality**: Communications with the White team are confidential.
- **Rule Updates**: Updated rules are available on the CyberForce Competition GitHub https://github.com/CyberForceCompetition/2026_CyberForce_Competition and noted as an #announcement in Discord. Participants are responsible for being informed of updates.

ALLOWED ACTIONS

- **Secure existing required services** on provided traditional VMs on their standard ports throughout the entire competition.
- **Harden/modify** any aspect of the following Traditional Infrastructure designated VMs (unless otherwise called out in the documentation): Mail/File Server (Windows 2019), Active Directory (Windows 2022), Task (OpenSuse Leap), and the Modbus PLC1 (Ubuntu 24).
- **Move and configure non-required services** within the traditional infrastructure.
- Use **only free or open-source software**; free trial software is ok if a credit card is not required and support from staff is not required. Additional AWS security software that is not inherent within your system is not allowed.
- Create **EC2 VM snapshots**.
- **Deploy innovative defense strategies** within rule constraints.
- **Help desk tickets** are required for support before and during the competition. No assistance in-person other than networking issues will be provided.
    - Tickets are **NOT** to verify answers or provide step-by-step actions for your infrastructure. Please ensure you have reviewed the rules, guidelines, and all material thoroughly and have done research prior to submitting a ticket.

PROHIBITED ACTIONS

- **No additional VMs**: The environment is limited to **SIX** VMs and ONE Anomaly VM. Seven total VMs.
- **No deleting provided machines**: If needed, restore from a snapshot instead.
- **No modification of the following users**: `SCORE1`, `SCORE2` & `PATCH` on traditional infrastructure.
- **Use extreme caution before modifying any Assume Breach VMs** (DNP3 PLC2: Debian 13 & HMI: Windows Server 2019). Any change that disrupts scoring or Red Team engagement can cost your team Red points. While monitoring tools may be installed, teams do so at their own risk, modifications that impact VM resources or usability may cost your team points.
- **IP blocking:** You may utilize firewalls and their functionality as normally intended, you may also block specific IP addresses, however you may **NOT** block entire subnets or utilize an Allow List. For example, you may block 192.168.0.14 but you may not block 192.168.0.0/27, or specifically allow certain IP addresses through such as the scoreboard. Please note, any blocked IP address may be used for scoring and any modifications teams make to their systems resulting in the scoreboard or specified users unable to reach said systems can result in point losses.

- **No branding** website, documentation, or video with university information.
- **No IP or machine name changes** to provided VMs.
- **No offensive actions** toward other Blue teams, the Red team, the Green team, scoreboard, the competition network/infrastructure, or the hosting venue infrastructure/network.
- **No AI tools** (e.g., ChatGPT) for anomaly resolution or infrastructure defense.

COMPETITION REQUIREMENTS

REQUIRED SERVICES AND PORT NUMBERS

All Blue teams are required to maintain the following services on the listed ports during the competition. If one of these services is on a provided VM, it must remain on that VM. If it is not there, it is the Blue team's responsibility to create that service on that port within that VM. This pre-existing service will be scored.

SERVICE	PORT #	BOX
HTTP	80	OpenSUSE Leap
OpenPLC	8080	Ubuntu 24.04
Modbus	502	Ubuntu 24.04

SERVICE	PORT #	BOX
MySQL	3306	OpenSuse Leap
SNMP	161	Windows 22
HFS	1080	Windows 19

SERVICE	PORT #	BOX
LDAP	389	Windows 22
SMB	139/445	OpenSuse Leap
SMTP	25	Windows 19

SCORING BREAKDOWN

Red Team	2500 points	25%
Blue Team	2500 points	25%
Green Team	1500 points	15%
Orange Team	2000 points	20%
Anomaly Scoring	1500 points	15%
Total	**10000 points**	**100%**

RED TEAM SCORING

TOTAL POINTS: 2500

- **Assume Breach** (1000 points): Teams must investigate and report attacks on Assume Breach VMs.
- **External Pentesting** (1500 points): Automated scans and penetration testing sessions.
- **Friday Red-Blue Check-in MANDATORY**:
    - Teams must check in with a Red team member on November 13, 2026. Check-ins begin at 9am CT and are 15 min in length and the final time slot is at 6PM CT.
    - Schedule your time within the Controller:
        - https://controller.cyberforcecompetition.com/competition/check-in
            1. Log into the Controller
            2. Click on “Schedule Red Team Check-In”

BLUE TEAM SCORING

TOTAL POINTS: 2500

- Service uptime, Geothermal production, and Radar Array uptime progress will be the ICS score portion.
- Points awarded for successfully maintaining the required operational services (p. 8) on their mandatory ports.

GREEN TEAM SCORING

TOTAL POINTS: 1500

TEAMS MUST UTILIZE THE WEBSITE PROVIDED FOR THEIR GREEN TEAM SCORING.

- Teams should review the Green team survey rubric and ensure their website meets outlined requirements.
- Your team must, the best of their ability, complete the website so that each of the questions below would be answered in the “True” statement.
- Green users are provided the “golden copy” images to validate your website against.
- Utilize only the images provided by the competition staff and **do not rename the images**.
- The website that Green team will be testing must be found on the Task VM.

ORANGE TEAM SCORING

TOTAL POINTS: 2000

C-SUITE PANEL BRIEF

POINTS: 1000

The C-Suite Panel is a pre-recorded video based on the task described below. Record your video and upload it to a platform accessible to judges (e.g., Google Drive, YouTube, Vimeo, Streamable). YOUTUBE LINKS ARE PREFERRED. The 2026 Scenario can be found in Github.

Before submitting, test your link to ensure it works. Then, submit the link in a text file (.txt) to the scoreboard by **MONDAY, NOVEMBER 2, 2026, AT 8AM PST**. Judges will begin reviewing videos shortly after.

- **Accessibility requirement:** Your video must remain accessible from NOVEMBER 2–14, 2026.

SECURITY DOCUMENTATION

POINTS: 1000

Blue team participants should use the Security Documentation to showcase their unique approaches to securing their infrastructure.

SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

- Use the **2026 CyberForce Competition Security Documentation Template**.
- Do **not** include university names, personal details, or any other identifying information, only your team number.
- Refer to the **2026 SecDoc Network Diagram Examples** for guidance.
- Submit your documentation as a **PDF** on the scoreboard by **MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026, AT 8AM PT**.

CONTENT EXPECTATIONS

- Documentation should cover **all infrastructure**, including **Assume Breach VMs***.
- Your role is to:
  - **Identify vulnerabilities** in the Assume Breach VMs.
  - **Identify and remediate vulnerabilities** in the Traditional VMs.
- Remember, this competition simulates a real-world scenario. **Presentation and professionalism** will influence your final score.

*** REMEMBER TO REFER TO THE ALLOWED AND PROHIBITED ACTIONS SECTIONS IN REGARD TO WHAT IS ALLOWED IN THE ASSUME BREACH VMS.**

ANOMALY SCORING

TOTAL POINTS: 1500

- Provided via USB on Friday, November 14.
- Password-protected files: attempting early access results in penalties.
  - Windows users will need 7zip or WinRAR to unzip the folder.
  - Linux and Unix users will utilize the gpg command.
- **Scoreboard Rules:**
  - Multiple attempts allowed for some anomalies.
  - Proper syntax required (case sensitivity indicated in question hints).

SUGGESTED SOFTWARE

Below is a list of software that is not required but will be extremely helpful in solving anomalies.

TOOL	PURPOSE
Google Lens	OSINT and CHROSINT challenges
Python 3.10+	Parsing challenges
CyberChef	Decoding challenges
Docker	Needed for an anomaly
Wireshark/Tshark	Analyzing PCAP files
Browser	Needed for an anomaly

PENALTIES

Penalties will be assessed if a Blue team does not abide by the competition rules and guidelines. Teams should be aware of the following penalty deductions:

- Reimaging of VMs outside of snapshot restoration = 75 points per reinstall per box
- Chronic password reset (more than 2 requests) = 50 points per request
- DMing admins or staff in Discord = 10 points per each violation per person
    - The ticket system and text channels are available for any questions or issues you may encounter.
- Failure to comply with VM naming guide during competition = 150 points per misnamed VM
    - Will be assessed by White team throughout the competition.
- Attempting to manipulate or otherwise compromise any bots or channels in the Discord server and/or the scoreboard = Disqualification
- Offensive action towards other teams' networks or hardware and/or network = Disqualification

RUBRICS

Rubric Definitions and Examples:

Targets a "senior leadership" audience → Avoid jargon. Be clear and concise.

With respect to the known vulnerabilities list, senior leadership will expect that your team processed and formatted the raw vulnerability data before it's presented to them in a clear and concise format. The organization of the vulnerability list should help "senior leadership" quickly understand their security posture. Presenting a raw "data dump" will distract them from the strategic, timely decision making that they need to make.

Diagrams make logical sense and are technically sound → The reader should be able to understand your diagram at a glance.

There are many good and bad ways to organize your diagram. For example, putting a WAN inside of your LAN is neither logical nor technically sound and therefore not a proficient diagram. Please note that rubric is silent with respect to whether the diagrams are hand-drawn or computer-drawn—either choice is acceptable.

Hardening steps → General steps that have been ***or*** will be taken to secure the team's competition environment.

Hardening steps are proactive steps taken to enhance the security posture of your system. Vulnerability management steps are reactive efforts that mitigate known, discovered weaknesses. Patching a firewall is vulnerability management (e.g., patch a known, exploitable vulnerability) whereas installing a firewall to segment the corporate network is a hardening step (e.g., add defense in depth). A single hardening step may consist of several actions (e.g., strong password management may require the rollout of password managers and account recovery systems).

Teams should not forget to document hardening steps for the assumed breach systems. But, per the competition rules, these steps cannot be implemented until the day of the competition.

Justification for steps → Explain to the reader why the steps taken (or planned to be taken) by your team were reasonable and justifiable.

Minimal - Answer is too terse (e.g. one-word answers) and does not clearly explain the justification.

Adequate - The justification is explained but is not based on best practices and/or well accepted principles.

Strong - Justification is based upon best practices and well accepted principles

Steps taken are reasonable → Steps should likely be approved by management, and they should be feasible for a team with limited resources (either tools or labor).

Use of AI Policy

Please note that senior leadership has not yet formalized a corporate AI policy. Until that happens, the interim policy is that all AI-generated content must be reviewed for accuracy and AI tool use must be properly cited. Your immediate manager has warned you that any use of "AI slop" within your group is unacceptable. You were told that the use of "AI slop" by another group embarrassed senior leadership, which is why they are developing a formal corporate AI policy.

SECURITY DOCUMENTATION RUBRIC

	0 - Not Present	1 – Emerging	2 – Developing	3-Proficient	4-Exemplary
System Overview (5%)	• Left blank or content not relevant	• Unclear definition of the system	• System defined	• System and its purpose are defined well	• System and its purpose are defined well in clear, plain language • Targets a "senior leadership" audience
Asset Inventory 10%)	• Left blank or content not relevant	• A few hosts are listed*	• A few hosts are listed* • A few services are listed	• Most hosts are listed • Most services are listed • Most OS, IP, and Port details are provided	• All hosts are listed* • All services are listed • All OS, IP, and Port details are provided
Network Diagram (20%)	• Left blank or content not relevant	• A few hosts are shown*	• Diagrams omit several major components of competition environment* • Diagrams have one or more gaps in technical or logical sense	• Diagram includes all major components of the competition environment • Diagram makes logical sense and is technically sound	• Diagram includes all assets located on competition network including logical connections and interconnects • Diagram makes logical sense and are technically sound • Appropriate and accepted symbols and terminology are used OR the diagram includes a legend for its color codes, symbols, etc.
Known Vulnerabilities (30%)	• Left blank or content not relevant	• Identified less than 10 vulnerabilities provided by the "build" crew • None or few of the listed vulnerabilities include an appropriate mitigation	• Identified some (<23) of the vulnerabilities provided by the "build" crew • Most listed vulnerabilities include an appropriate mitigation	• Identified many (≥23) of the vulnerabilities provided by the "build" crew • Most vulnerabilities have an appropriate mitigation* • Vulnerability list is organized	• Identified most (we won't tell you how many) of the vulnerabilities provided by the "build" crew • Identified vulnerabilities, if any, with user and system accounts • All vulnerabilities have an appropriate mitigation • Vulnerability list is organized • Targets a "senior leadership" audience
System Hardening (25%)	• Left blank or content not relevant	• Hardening steps (0-1) are taken but lack comprehensiveness or technical competence • No justification for steps the team did or did not take (or plan to take) • Steps taken do not align with expectations • Utilized non-approved software/hardware	• Hardening steps (1-2) are taken but lack comprehensiveness or technical competence • Minimal justification for steps the team did or did not take (or plan to take) • Steps taken do not align with expectations • Utilizes a mix of non-approved and approved software/hardware	• Hardening steps (3+) are comprehensive and technically sound • Adequate justification for steps the team did or did not take (or plan to take) • Most steps taken are reasonable • Only utilized open source / free toolsets	• Hardening steps (4+) are comprehensive and technically sound • Strong justification for steps the team did or did not take (or plan to take or not) • All steps taken are reasonable • Only utilized open source / free toolsets
Professionalism and Formatting (10%)	• Did not use the provided template • Inappropriate content included	• Document is hastily completed or unformatted • Material is presented in an ad-hoc fashion • Little or no technical language is used • Spelling and grammar errors greatly detract from content	• Document has sections that are formatted differently • Presentation of materials detracts from overall effectiveness • Misuse or lack of technical language throughout the document • Many spelling or grammar errors	• Document looks presentable, but some areas may contain incorrect formatting or lack aesthetic appeal • Most of the document contains correct terminology • Some spelling or grammatical errors	• Document has aesthetic appeal • Correct terminology used as appropriate throughout • No major spelling or grammatical errors

Note: The asset inventory and network diagram should be consistent. If they are not, then points may be deducted from either or both categories.
Definitions: *Most* means 70+%. *All* means 90+%.

C-SUITE PANEL BRIEF (VIDEO) RUBRIC

	0 - Not Present	1 – Emerging	2 – Developing	3-Proficient	4-Exemplary
Presentation Requirements (8%)	• Required elements are missing. • Video file has no sound, is corrupt, or unviewable by the scoring team.	• Video introduction does not include Team ID# • Video is significantly shorter or longer than 5 minutes. • Only one team member can be identified as a participant in any way.	• Video includes Team ID#. • Video is longer or shorter than ~5 minutes (less than 3 minutes or more than 7 minutes). • Only one team member is an active presenter. • Additional team members are acknowledged.	• Video includes Team ID#. • Video length is approximately 5 minutes but too long or too short for amount of relevant information provided. • Two equally active presenters are in the video. • Acknowledgement of contributions from some team members.	• Video includes Team ID#. • Video length is approximately 5 minutes, and all time is used well. • Two or more active team members participate equally. • Clear acknowledgment of contributions from all (either on- or off-screen) team members.
Risk Analysis and Mission Impact (20%)	• Risks and consequences are not discussed or are unrelated to the scenario.	• Identifies one risk or consequence, but discussion is vague, inaccurate, or not connected to VDL's mission or operations.	• Identifies at least two risks or consequences. • Provides limited discussion of how those risks or consequences could affect VDL mission and business objectives.	• Identifies two relevant risks and explains the potential impact on VDL's mission and business objectives. • Discussion demonstrates clear understanding of potential organizational impacts. • Presentation is not suitable for all members of the C-Suite (e.g., excessive jargon and technical details).	• Identifies at least three significant risks and explains their potential impact on VDL's mission and business. • Clearly distinguishes between the risk itself and the resulting consequence. • Uses business-focused language appropriate for executive leadership.
Service Prioritization & Tradeoff Decision (30%)	• No prioritization recommendation is provided.	• Recommendation for service priority is unclear, unsupported, or fails to recognize consequences of the decision.	• Makes a recommendation of service priority with limited justification. • Tradeoffs, consequences, or accepted risks of the selected approach are only partially addressed.	• Presents a clear service priority recommendation supported by logical reasoning. • Demonstrates understanding of benefits, drawbacks, and risks associated with the chosen approach.	• Presents a clear, defensible service priority recommendation supported by strong evidence and executive-level reasoning. • Explicitly identifies tradeoffs, accepted risks, affected stakeholders, and operational consequences. • Acknowledges uncertainty and explains circumstances that could justify changing priorities
Operational Action Plan (30%)	• No meaningful actions are proposed.	• Actions are unrealistic, unsupported, or require resources beyond those available in the scenario.	• Identifies one or more relevant actions. • Provides limited implementation details or weak connections to the problems being addressed. • Indicators or conditions provided for leadership to use to determine need for adjustment are difficult to measure.	• Recommends two or more realistic actions that use existing resources or add no addition cost. • Explains what VDL will do and the problem it solves. • Partially explains who is responsible and what will be delay, etc. to make it happen. • Establishes indicators or conditions that signal needed adjustment to leadership	• Recommends two or three well-prioritized actions that use existing resources and effectively address identified challenges. • Clearly explains what VDL will do, who is responsible, what problem is solved, and what organizational tradeoffs are required. • Establishes measurable indicators or conditions that leadership can use to determine when priorities or actions need adjustment.
Stakeholder Communications (12%)	• Stakeholder communication is not addressed.	• Communication recommendations are vague, incomplete, or fail to identify key stakeholders.	• Identifies some stakeholders and communication needs but messaging lacks clarity, purpose, or relevance.	• Identifies major stakeholder groups and recommends appropriate communications. • Clearly identifies the decision or commitment needed from leadership.	• Develops a clear stakeholder communication strategy that addresses expectations, trust, transparency, and organizational objectives. • Clearly articulates the specific decision, approval, commitment, or risk acceptance required from the C-Suite and explains why executive action is necessary.
Quality of Presentation (5%)	• Presentation does not follow scenario guidelines.	• Inappropriate dress code—team is not dressed for a work environment. • Many visual distractions. • Inappropriate visual aids, slides or other on-screen materials.	• Appropriate dress code—team is dressed for a work environment. • Few visual distractions. • Visual aids, slides or other materials lack professionalism.	• Appropriate dress code—team is dressed for a work environment. • Minimal visual distractions. • Visual aids, slides and other materials are acceptable.	• Appropriate dress code—team is dressed for a work environment. • Visual aids, slides and other materials have a consistent, professional appearance.

GREEN TEAM SURVEY

1. ENSURE SITE LOADS. I was able to connect to task.blueXXXX.cfc.local. If unable to connect, then please mark false for the remaining questions. See the landing page image (website 1).	**True**	**False**
2. CHECK THE SITE COLOR. All site accent colors should be Orange: #ea4524.	**True**	**False**
3. CHECK THE NAVIGATION BAR ORDER. The top navigation bar should read from left to right: Home | About Us | Subscribe | Login	**True**	**False**
4. CHECK HOME BACKGROUND IMAGE. Just below the navigation bar on the home page, there should be a photo banner named volcano-1.png (found in the WordPress media library) Page depicted in the image (website 1).	**True**	**False**
5. CHECK THE HOME TAGLINE. The tagline in front of the home background image should read, **Transforming ideas into innovation with AI and human expertise.** **Explore conversations from our CEO on emerging technology, strategy, and the future of the industry across leading platforms and even RSS.**	**True**	**False**
6. CHECK ABOUT US OPTIONS. On the About Us page, there should sections with provided information, such as: Our core competencies include: Dynamic Vulcanization Framework Our Mission Our Vision Our Values	**True**	**False**
7. CHECK IF ADMIN MIDDLEWARE IS WORKING. Click **Login**. You should be able to login to the user with the following credentials: *username = green-user* *password = password* While logged in, you should not see the "**Admin**" button, next to "**Logout**". If you are able to login and there is not an Admin button present, mark True. If you cannot log in or the Admin button is there, mark False. **Ensure you log out**.	**True**	**False**
8. CHECK IF ADMIN USERS ARE LISTED. Click **Login**. You should be able to login to the user with the following credentials: *username = green-admin* *password = password* You should be able to check the current users registered within the site by clicking on the "Users" button within the Admin dashboard. The users **'blue'** and '**green-admin'** should have the admin tags. If you cannot log in or either user does not have an Admin tag, mark False.	**True**	**False**
9. CHECK FOOTER TEXT. The Footer Text is located on the bottom of every webpage, and it should read: *VULCANA DYNAMICS LTD.* *(708) 867-5309* *18451 Convention Center Dr.* *Tinley Park, IL 60477*	**True**	**False**
10. CHECK THE GEOTHERMAL DATA PAGE. On the Geothermal Data page, the page should provide data charts depicting: "Total Power Generated" "Power Generated" "City Draw" "Radar Draw" If you are unable to get to the Geothermal Data Page or there is no data showing, mark False. See image (website 2).	**True**	**False**
11. CHECK THE LOGOS IN THE HEADER. There is a logo for Vulcana Dynamics Ltd. within the site navigation bar. See the image (website 1).	**True**	**False**
12. ENSURE THE CHAT BOT HELPER WORKS There is a chatbot located at the bottom right-hand corner of the page. Ensure that the chatbot opens when clicked on, and when asked about Vulcana with the message "tell me about Vulcana" it responds with some information about the company written within the webpage. Response: "Vulcana Dynamics Ltd. is a globally synergistic leader in next-generation strategic technological enablement solutions. Founded with a commitment to innovation, disruption, and moving the needle, we transform complexity into opportunity."	**True**	**False**